



New drivers fix RTX 3080 crashes

Nvidia's latest drivers fix RTX 3080 crashes, but at the cost of some clock speed.
<http://dgit.in/oct20-73>



Shapeshifting wool

Researchers at Harvard have created a wool-like 3D-printable material that can shape shift. <http://dgit.in/oct20-74>

Nokia 5.3

Missed opportunity

The Nokia 5.3, which was announced back in March, finally launched today in India, armed with a Qualcomm Snapdragon 665 SoC, a quad-camera setup and more. Let's find out how this smartphone fared in our review.

Design and display

Like most Nokia smartphones, the R&D team has put exceptional attention to detail, carving a smartphone that's ergonomic, non-slippery and easy to use. The material is plastic and there's Gorilla Glass 3 protection on the display, but it's the finishing that exudes premium. The 6.53-inch display, however, takes away from the exquisite design. The 720p resolution can be made out when placed beside the Redmi Note 9, and it's barely visible out in the sun.

Camera

The camera is what the marketing claims will be the reason to own this phone. Well, the 13MP primary camera at the back is indeed a good shooter. But the other three lenses could do much better to take on the competition.

The daylight output from the 13MP primary camera is crispy sharp, with adequate dynamic range and saturated hues. However, in low light, even with the Night Mode turned on, the Nokia 5.3's camera feels horribly outdated. The low-light shots come out shaky, full of noise and with no detail whatsoever.

The 5MP ultrawide lens produces good photos when the light is optimal but the quality goes down swiftly when shooting indoors or under low light. The Night Mode also works with the ultrawide lens, but the results are of no good. There's also an 8MP selfie camera that produces good selfie portraits but relies heavily on beauty filters.



BUILD	54
FEATURES	48
PERFORMANCE	40
VALUE	64

Software

Nokia is one of the few brands that are still committed to Google's Android One programme, and the Nokia 5.3's software is the same as the Google Pixel, sans the Pixel-exclusive features. With no additional third-party apps, the Nokia 5.3 is

the cleanest Android skin to use, and also the simplest.

Despite the Pixel-like software, the experience of using the phone is far from smooth. The smartphone feels slow and sluggish in daily use and requires a lot of patience for daily usage. That's because even the first-party apps like Dialer, Camera and Gmail take upwards of 5 seconds to launch from cold.

So even with an ad-free, no-frills Android skin, the Nokia 5.3 struggles to offer an experience that's reliable enough for prolonged daily use.

Performance

Even while most mid-rangers under ₹15,000 are coming with MediaTek's chipsets, Nokia chose to stick to the Qualcomm Snapdragon 665 SoC. The gulf in performance is significant when compared against its Chinese rivals — The Redmi Note 9 and the Realme 6i. Benchmark scores peg the Snapdragon 665 lower than even the

MediaTek Helio G80 powering the Realme 6i and the Narzo 10. This is consistent across all benchmark apps we ran.

Coming to gaming, the Adreno 610 GPU in the Nokia 5.3 had so far proved inferior to the competition. At the highest graphics settings, CoD: Mobile on the Nokia 5.3 manages a paltry 28 FPS, but with 100 percent stability. The gameplay feels sluggish as a whole, but there are no additional frame drops. So if you can get used to playing at low frame rates, you wouldn't mind a few rounds on this phone.

Coming to battery life, with nothing in the smartphone that can draw too much power, the Nokia 5.3 manages well over a day with a 4000mAh battery on board. The battery consumption is conservative if you just stick to browsing, texting and calling. But running the benchmark apps, heavy use of the camera, watching an episode of Black Mirror on Netflix and playing a 30-minute match of PUBG Mobile will drain the battery by evening. Also, there's no fast charging on this phone.

Bottomline

In all, the Nokia 5.3 comes out as a missed opportunity. With strong demand for non-Chinese smartphones in the market, this could have been the right moment for HMD Global to swoop in and capture the market, but the Nokia 5.3 would be an inferior choice amidst the likes of the Xiaomi Redmi Note 9, Realme Narzo 10, and even the Samsung Galaxy M20. The gaming performance is poor and every camera other than the primary one is subpar. All things said and done, you can give this one a skip.

—Subhrojit Mallick

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY: 6.55-inch (720x1600) | PROCESSOR: Qualcomm Snapdragon 665 | FRONT CAMERA: 8MP | REAR CAMERA: 13MP (primary) + 5MP (ultrawide) + 2MP (macro) + 2MP (depth) | RAM: 4GB | Storage: 64GB | Battery CAPACITY: 4000mAh | CHARGING: 10W | OS: Android 10, Android One | WEIGHT: 185 g | BLUETOOTH: 4.2 | FINGERPRINT SENSOR: Rear-mounted

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